

DAY 24: CELEBRATE BIRTHDAYS ON A BUDGET

Although I'm not a huge fan of getting older (okay, I have a *major* phobia when it comes to aging!), I love everything about birthdays. I look forward to eating my favorite ice cream cake, unwrapping thoughtful gifts, and trying to guess what special activities Joseph has planned for me this year. He definitely spoils me!

But as much fun as birthdays are to have yourself, they are tons of fun to plan for others too. I could spend hours browsing Pinterest and creating themed birthday boards for just about any party. Don't even get me started on all the DIY projects that take your bash to the next level. Put me in charge and you can guarantee I'll go a teensy bit overboard.

As with any celebration, though, there's food to buy, favors to purchase, decorations to coordinate, and activities to plan. If money's no object, sure, it's much easier to just go to the store and buy everything you need without worrying about the cost. But for a frugal girl like me, it's hard to justify spending so much on a one-day event when I have many other goals in mind for my money.

But what if you could have both? You know, host a beautiful birthday party without spending much at all?

These five budget-friendly ideas are proof you can make that happen. Plus, you'll find that the smaller your budget, the more creative you can be. Your next bash may be the best one you've thrown yet!

1. DITCH THE YEARLY PARTY

As much fun as it is to have a party every year, it's not a necessity. My parents were very intentional about our birthday parties, and we were allowed to have two major ones growing up (when we turned six, and then again when we turned thirteen).